

The Loaded Level Model

A beginner's guide · no jargon assumed · read the pages in order

There is one idea underneath this whole method, and everything else is machinery built on top of it.

You are trading other traders' stop losses.

Every trader who buys puts a stop loss somewhere below where they bought. Every trader who sells puts one above. Those stops are real orders sitting in the market, waiting. When enough of them pile up in one place, the market has a reason to go there and collect them — and once it has, it very often turns around and goes the other way.

So the whole skill is answering one question: **where are the stops?**

THE MISTAKE ALMOST EVERYONE MAKES

Most people are taught that there is money resting above every high and below every low. If that were true your chart would have a hundred targets on it and you would have no idea which to trade. Marco, the trader this model comes from, says this directly:

"There's a lot of people out there like to say there's liquidity above every high and low. Right then and there the novice trader is going to think — there's highs and lows all over my chart, what do I do?"

Most highs and lows have nothing at them. The market has to *show* you which ones are worth anything. That test is the next page, and it is the single most important thing in this document.

A word you will see everywhere here. When we say a level is **LOADED**, we mean traders have committed money there and their stops are sitting behind it. When we say a level is **EMPTY**, we mean the market has already been there, taken those stops, and left. Loaded and empty are the only two words you need.

WHAT YOU WILL BE ABLE TO DO BY THE END

1. Look at a bare chart and mark the two or three levels that actually matter.
2. Recognise a complete setup as it builds, step by step.
3. Know exactly where your entry, your stop and your target go — and why each is there.
4. Know the six situations where the correct action is to do nothing.

This handout describes a model taught publicly by Marco / Inter Equity Trading, also known as the "Da Vinci" model. The rules are his. The measurements on page 7 are ours.

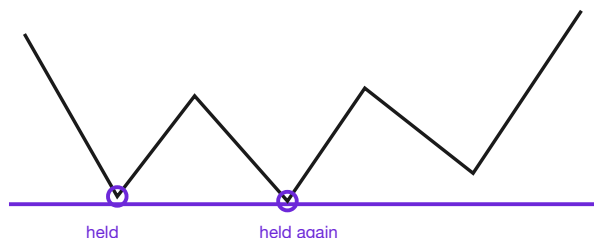
Loaded, or empty?

This is the test. Everything else follows from it.

A level is LOADED when price came back to it, held it, and walked away.

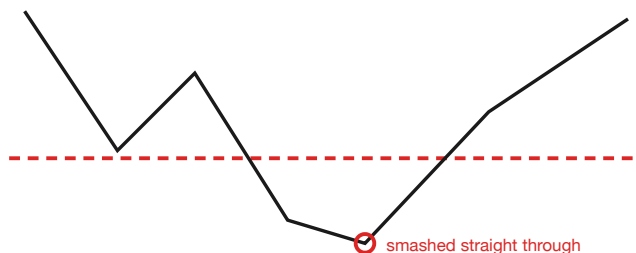
That is the whole test. Price has to *return*. If price made a high once and never went back near it, nothing happened there — nobody committed money, so there are no stops. It is just a high.

LOADED — worth marking



Buyers got in here. Their stops are sitting just under this line.

EMPTY — a "liquidity block"



Those stops are gone. Nothing is left here to pull price back.

Left: price returned and held — the level is loaded. Right: price went through and kept going — the level is now empty.

WHY YOU CARE ABOUT EACH ONE

A LOADED level

Has money behind it. You use it two ways:

Smash it → entry. When price finally breaks a loaded level, all those traders get stopped out at once. That is the fuel for the move. You join in the moment it happens.

Aim at it → target. The stops sitting there are what pulls price toward it. That is why your target is a level and not a round number.

An EMPTY level

Has nothing behind it. You use it one way, and it is the most important job in the model:

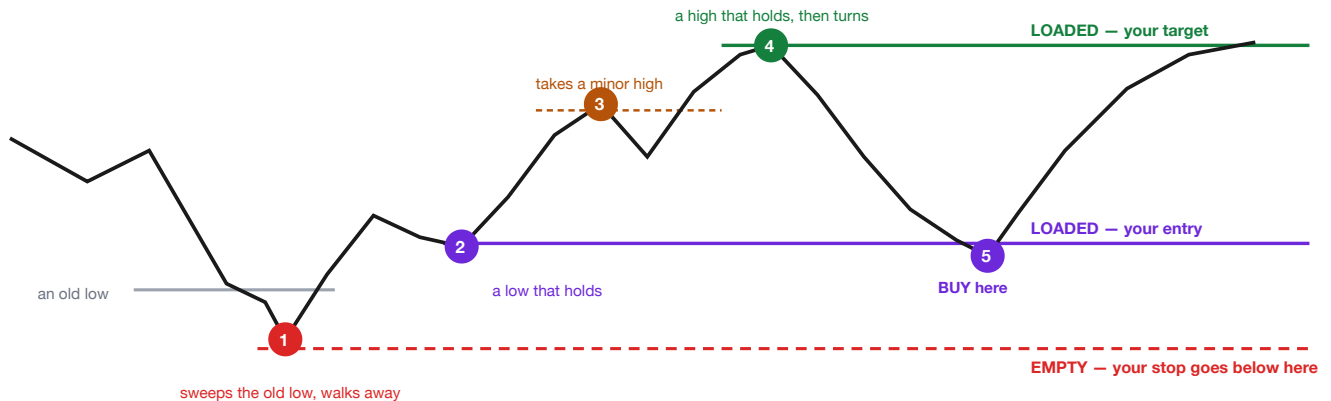
Hide your stop behind it. The market has already collected what was there. It has no errand back down. So your stop, tucked just past it, is in the one place on the chart the market is least interested in.

Marco's phrase: "*trust these highs and trust these lows.*"

The rule that keeps your chart clean. If price never came back and held it, do not draw a line on it. This one rule is the difference between a chart with three meaningful levels on it and a chart with forty meaningless ones.

The setup, step by step

Six steps. Shown as a buy. A sell is the exact mirror — turn the page upside down and every word still applies.



- 1 Price sweeps an old low and walks away.** That low is now empty. Two things just happened: you only look for buys from here on, and *you already know where your stop will live*.
- 2 A level loads.** Price bounces, then pulls back and makes a low that holds above an earlier one. Buyers are now in, with stops underneath. **Mark this level. This is where you will buy.** Then leave it alone.
- 3 Inducement.** Price pushes up and takes out a small high. More buyers pile in, late. They are fuel for what comes next.
- 4 The target loads.** Price makes a high that holds against earlier highs, then turns away. Sellers are now committed up there with stops above them. **This step is the gate — see the box below.**
- 5 Entry.** Price sells back down and stabs through your level from step 2. Buy the moment it goes. Do not wait for the candle to close. Do not hunt a better price inside it.
- 6 Stop and target.** Stop just below the empty level from step 1. Target the loaded high from step 4.

Step 4 is the gate, and it is the step beginners skip. If there is no loaded level above to aim at, **there is no trade** — no matter how good steps 1 to 3 looked. Marco's words: "*no engineered liquidity, no model*." Without step 4 you are just buying a dip and hoping.

Reading strength

All loaded levels are worth marking. Some are worth much more than others.

Once you can spot a loaded level, the next skill is judging how *much* is sitting behind it. Three things tell you, and all three are just careful looking — no indicator required.

1 · HOW LONG PRICE SPENT ON ONE SIDE OF IT

The longer price hovers above a low without breaking it, the more people have bought there and the more stops have stacked underneath. Marco points at a five-and-a-half-hour build and says:

"This is for hours, guys. Hours and hours and hours ... we traded above this low for 5½ hours. So just imagine how much liquidity was being built below this low."

Judge it in candles, not in clock time. Twenty candles of grinding is the same signal on a 1-minute chart as on an hourly one. That is what makes this work on any timeframe.

2 · HOW MANY TIMES IT HELD

Once is a level. Twice is a better level. Three or four times and a lot of people are watching it. He counts out loud on the chart — *"once, twice, three times"* — because each touch adds another layer of orders.

3 · HOW VIOLENTLY IT WAS TAKEN

When the sweep finally comes, look at how fast it happened. Two big candles erasing thirteen hours of patient grinding is a far stronger signal than a slow drift through.

"Look at the volume. One, two candles. Two candles sweep out what, 12, 13 hours of price action."

WHERE THESE LEVELS USUALLY ARE

You do not have to hunt randomly. Loaded levels cluster in predictable places:

LEVEL	WHY TRADERS ARE THERE
Yesterday's high and low	Watched by almost everybody. Stops stack just past them.
The previous session's high and low	Asia's range, then London's — each one becomes the next session's target.
Equal highs / equal lows	Two or more touches at the same price. Obvious to everyone, which is the point.
The previous candle's high or low	On any timeframe. When a candle closes leaving the one before it un-swept, the next candle often goes and takes it.
Round numbers	People place orders at tidy prices.

Sweeps like to happen at the start of something. A new hourly candle, a session open, the minutes after a news release. If your level gets taken right as London opens, that is not a coincidence — it is the most common time for it.

When to do nothing

Marco spends more time on this than on entries. So should you.

Most of the time, the right answer is that there is no trade. That is not you failing to find one — it is the model working. Here are the six situations where you stand down.

THE SITUATION	WHY YOU STAY OUT
1 Nothing to aim at	No loaded level on the far side. You have no target, so you have no trade, however good the entry looks. " <i>When you don't see liquidity, we wait.</i> "
2 Liquidity still sitting in the way	There is an un-swept pool between you and your target — often off to the left of the screen. Price will go and take that first. Wait until it has.
3 Price is on the wrong side of the pool	You want to buy below a low that has not been swept yet. Until price actually goes below it, every rally is a trap. Do nothing and stop caring about the wiggles.
4 The stop would be too wide	If the empty level is far away, your stop is huge and the reward no longer justifies it. First try dropping one timeframe to find a closer one. If you still cannot, skip the trade.
5 A quiet inside day	After a day that swept both yesterday's high <i>and</i> its low, the next day often just chops around inside that range. Poor conditions. Trade smaller or not at all.
6 A move that came from nothing	If a rally started at no level you had marked, it is not a real move — it is bait. Do not chase it. If anything, it is a clue to trade the other way.

TWO TRAPS WORTH NAMING

A reaction at your level is not a signal

Price will often bounce off a level *without* the setup completing. That bounce is not the trade starting — it is more orders being built for later. Wait for the full sequence, not the first flicker.

Do not buy toward liquidity that is still above you

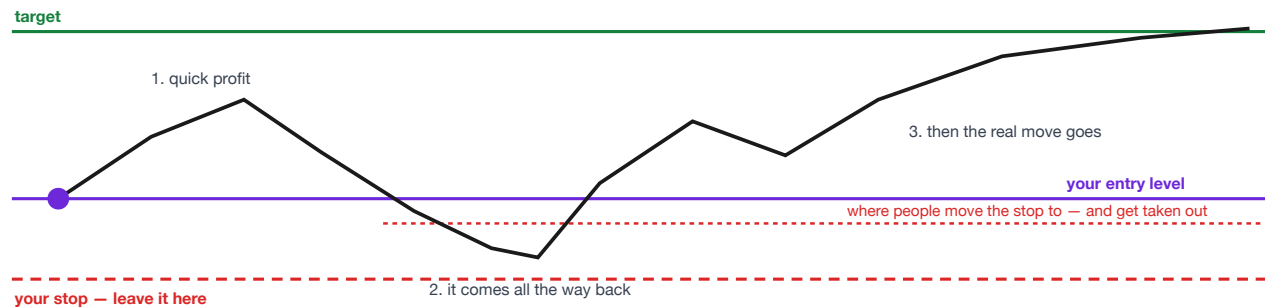
If there is an un-swept high overhead, price wants to go and take it. Buying into that is buying just before the market collects the stops of everyone who did the same. Let it get taken first, *then* look.

How often should this actually fire? Marco says the really good ones come **a couple of times a week at best, sometimes once or twice a month.** If you are finding several a day, you have almost certainly loosened the rules without noticing.

After you are in

The trade is *expected* to go against you. This page is why people lose on a setup that eventually worked.

Here is the sequence that plays out again and again after entry:



- 1 You get a fast move in your favour.** You are in profit quickly. It feels great.
- 2 Price comes all the way back** — often making a new extreme first. This is the market inducing one last batch of traders before it goes. It is normal. It is expected.
- 3 Then the real move happens** and runs to your target.

The single most expensive mistake in this model. At step 1, feeling clever, people move their stop up to lock in the profit. At step 2, that new stop gets hit. Then they watch step 3 happen without them.

Do not move your stop because the trade went your way. Marco warns about this in four separate videos and shows the exact trade where it costs you the winner.

SO WHEN MAY YOU MOVE IT?

When something actually happens on the chart — not when a certain amount of profit appears. The trigger is **a level being taken**. Once price has run the next pool of liquidity on the way to your target, that part of the job is done and you may protect the trade.

"As soon as we take out this high, we can all agree that liquidity has been taken. So manage your risk." — and, put the other way: "we're only ever going to touch the stop loss once the trade starts moving in the intended direction, and a good bit as well, not just a couple of pips."

TAKING PROFIT

Targets are levels, not numbers you invent. Take the first one at the nearest loaded level, and if you want to hold a piece for a bigger one, aim at the loaded level on the higher timeframe. Marco is explicit that exactly how much you take at each is personal — *"do what you're comfortable with"* — but he will not bother banking at less than about **3 times** his risk.

If it stops you out, the idea may still be right. As long as your target is still sitting there un-swept, the direction has not been proven wrong — you were just early. Wait for a new level to load and take it again.

What we actually measured

Read this page before you risk money. It is the part no video gives you.

Across sixteen videos teaching this model there is **no win rate, no number of trades, and no equity curve** — not once. So we coded the sequence ourselves and ran it over eight years of gold data to see what is actually there.

XAUUSD, 15-minute bars, 186,759 bars, September 2018 to August 2026. Every setup is scored against **random trades with the same direction, the same stop distance and the same target distance** — because on a market that tripled in price, any buying rule looks clever unless you check it against luck.

SIDE	TRADES	WON	RANDOM DID	EDGE	VERDICT
Buys	49	34.7%	22.9%	+11.8 pts	Real, but a small sample
Sells	80	21.2%	20.9%	+0.4 pts	No better than random

WHAT THAT MEANS IN PLAIN ENGLISH

1. **The buy side showed a genuine edge** — it won noticeably more often than luck with the same stop and target. After a realistic spread it still made money.
2. **The sell side showed nothing at all.** Identical detection, no edge. We do not yet know whether that is the model or our code.
3. **49 trades in eight years is a very small sample.** That is about six a year. A result this size is a hint, not a proof.
4. **The edge only appeared on the high-reward setups.** When we allowed trades with a reward smaller than twice the risk, the advantage over random **vanished completely**.

Point 4 is the useful one, and it matches what Marco says. He insists on waiting for "*the higher probable ones*" and will not take a trade under roughly 3:1. Our numbers agree: the patience is not a preference, it appears to be where the whole edge lives.

Do not read this page as a green light

One instrument, one timeframe, one set of settings, a small number of trades, and a simplified way of deciding whether the stop or the target was hit first. This is early work. **Nobody should be sizing up on this yet.**

THINGS NOBODY HAS PINNED DOWN

Honest gaps, so you know what you are judging by eye rather than by rule: how many candles of building is "enough"; how close a return counts as "holding" the level; how long a level stays empty before it matters again; and what hours of the day to trade — Marco skips setups outside his own trading window but has never said what that window is.

Your checklist

Print this page. Work down it in order, every single time.

BEFORE YOU LOOK FOR A TRADE

- ☐ Start on the higher timeframe. If nothing is there, do not drop lower.
- ☐ Mark only levels that price **returned to and held**.
- ☐ Find the empty level — the one price smashed and left. That is where risk can sit.
- ☐ Ask: is there a loaded level on the far side to aim at? If no, stop here.
- ☐ Ask: is anything un-swept in the way? If yes, wait for it.

THE SETUP

- ☐ 1 · An old level was swept and price walked away.
- ☐ 2 · A level has loaded. It is marked. I have not touched it since.
- ☐ 3 · A minor high or low was taken — latecomers are in.
- ☐ 4 · A level has loaded on the far side. **This is my target.**

THE TRADE

- ☐ Entry: the instant my level from step 2 is stabbed. No waiting, no better price.
- ☐ Stop: just past the empty level. Written down before I click.
- ☐ Target: the loaded level from step 4.
- ☐ Reward is at least 3× my risk — or I do not take it.

ONCE I AM IN

- ☐ I expect it to come back against me. That is normal.
- ☐ I will **not** move my stop because I am in profit.
- ☐ I will only move it once a level has actually been taken.
- ☐ If I am stopped and the target is still un-swept, the idea stands. I wait for the next one.

STOP AND WALK AWAY IF...

- ☐ There is nothing to aim at.
- ☐ The stop would be too wide to justify.
- ☐ It is a quiet inside day.
- ☐ I am about to chase a move that started from nothing.

You are trading other traders' stop losses.

Smash a loaded level to get in. Hide behind an empty one. Aim at another loaded one.

Model taught by Marco / Inter Equity Trading. Measurements on page 7 are our own and are early-stage. Nothing here is financial advice — test everything yourself before risking money.